

The protocol on biosecurity data and information sharing (the Protocol) supports a core commitment of the IGAB to share biosecurity information, data, intelligence and other knowledge necessary for the efficient functioning of the national biosecurity system.

The intent of the Protocol is to encourage a culture of sharing data and information except where there are legal or other significant impediments. Parties are responsible for ensuring that it is lawful to share data and information according to the laws that apply in their jurisdiction.

The Protocol:

- expands upon the agreement established by the IGAB by providing greater guidance around the two-way sharing of data and information to support the management of biosecurity risks
- recognises multilateral sharing of data and information (between Commonwealth and jurisdictional agencies) including that of a sensitive nature is needed to prevent, mitigate and manage the impact of potential or actual biosecurity risks, and those events and issues that may impact the export of Australian agricultural products.

The Protocol came into effect on 4 October 2018. It aligns with the whole of government [Intergovernmental Agreement on Data Sharing](#) (see below).

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Intergovernmental Agreement on Data Sharing

The [Intergovernmental Agreement on Data Sharing](#) (the Agreement) commits all jurisdictions to share public sector data as a default position, where it can be done securely, safely, lawfully and ethically.

The Agreement:

- sets out commitments and guiding principles for the Australian Government, and state and territory governments
- recognises data as a shared national asset and aims to maximise the value of data to deliver outstanding policies and services for Australians.

It is signed by:

- the Prime Minister
- premiers
- chief ministers.

The Agreement came into effect on 9 July 2021, when it was signed by National Cabinet.